

Valentin Nikolaev

Senior Backend Engineer

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Summary

Senior backend engineer with 15+ years of experience designing, operating, and troubleshooting production systems. Recent work spans Go services, event-driven pipelines, AWS, Kubernetes, queues, observability, CI/CD, and AI-assisted automation. Experienced in turning real operational requirements into reliable services, defining failure behavior, improving performance, and documenting systems for other engineers and stakeholders.

Skills

- Go
- Backend system design
- Distributed systems
- Event-driven architecture
- AWS
- Kubernetes
- CI/CD automation
- Queues and messaging
- Durable delivery patterns
- Observability and monitoring
- Production troubleshooting
- REST APIs
- MySQL and PostgreSQL
- Reliability engineering
- Technical documentation

Experience

Simple.life

Software Developer November 2023 - July 2026

- Designed and owned a Go-based support-automation platform connecting Zendesk, Intercom, and internal services.
- Built resilient message-delivery flows with retries, fallback logic, monitoring, and operational safeguards.
- Integrated AI-assisted triage that handled or deflected up to 30% of inbound tickets.
- Migrated business-critical workflows between platforms while maintaining production continuity.

CRURATED

Software Developer August 2024 - January 2026

- Architected an event-driven analytics system using queues and AWS EventBridge.
- Increased throughput to the data lake by more than 10x and maintained delivery reliability above 99.9%.
- Defined versioned event schemas, routing to Webhook and S3 destinations, retries, backpressure handling, and observability.
- Reduced implementation time for new analytics streams from several days to under four hours through modular design.

airSlate

Senior Software Developer / Technical Lead February 2021 - August 2023

- Migrated services from ECS to Kubernetes and prepared Helm, GitHub Actions, and ArgoCD delivery pipelines on AWS.
- Reduced peak database workload, diagnosed API and query bottlenecks, and improved production service stability.
- Troubleshoot incidents with logs, monitoring, Prometheus, and SRE dashboards.
- Planned delivery, coordinated team work, and conducted more than 20 technical interviews.

Hypr

Technical Lead November 2019 - January 2021

- Helped bring a web platform from prototype to closed beta in under six months.
- Defined microservice, serverless, CI/CD, and reliability decisions with the CTO.
- Contributed directly to Go and PHP backend development on AWS and Kubernetes.

PDFfiller

Software Developer / Technical Lead October 2016 - November 2019

- Led five backend engineers operating a transactional email platform at around 50 million messages per month.
- Designed queue-backed delivery components and supported more than 10x traffic growth during BFCM periods.
- Built operational expertise across RabbitMQ, MySQL, Elasticsearch, AWS, monitoring, and failure handling.

Education

MSc in Computer Science National Technical University, Kharkiv, Ukraine | 2003 - 2008

Languages

- Ukrainian — Native
- English — Upper-intermediate